

We've seen workstations being built by enthusiasts who prefer to have a lot of cores on hand for video and 3D rendering work.

What choice do I have?

While tech is supposed to be definitive, ironically, the answer to this question is "it depends". Fortunately, we can be more definitive about what it depends on. If you search online, you might be able to spots gems like these: <http://bit.ly/Flipkart775> . Please do not fall for such components. Although they were good performers, the problem with such components is that they are old and you might not find other components that are compatible. E.g. It is difficult to find a motherboard that goes with LGA775 socket. Also the processor itself has reached End of Interactive Support status from its manufacturer Intel.

Basic Rig

You are looking for a basic processor, possibly with a built-in graphics unit as you do not want to use a discreet graphics card. Also, we believe you are not looking for a lot of gaming.

You can go for AMD A8-7600 APU with 4 processing cores clocking between 3.1 to 3.8 GHz and 4 MB of L2 shared cache.

Entry Level Gaming

You need a decent punch with multi-threaded processing in this case with a higher single core performance. You could go for a Intel Core i3 – 7100 for your CPU which can deliver good speeds with 2 cores / 4 threads and 3MB of smartcache and supports the latest hardware developments on the multimedia end.

Mid-Range

You need a machine which can do more than just basic tasks. You need more cache and more computation power. AMD Ryzen 5 1400 is priced well and comes with 4 cores and 8MB cache. It supports DDR4 on 2 channels and can address up to 64 GB of memory. A neat performer at an affordable price.

High-end

Intel Core i5 – 7600 has 4 processors that can run 4 threads at a time (no SMT/HT here). The processor also supports most technologies developed